

Friendship Circle

Judith Orloff

From: Rabbi Yehuda Shemtov [yshemtov@earthlink.net]
Sent: Thursday, January 15, 2004 7:45 AM
To: Judith Orloff
Cc: Zalman@NJJewish.com
Subject: RE: FC PowerPoint Presentation

hi judith,
i have answered to the best of my ability. i have also cc'd this to rabbi zalman grossbaum one of the leaders of this program. i think he should be part of all correspondence on this project.

zalman- can you add your views on these issues?

thanks for your time,
rs

-----Original Message-----

From: Judith Orloff [mailto:jorloff@o-dconsulting.com]
Sent: Monday, January 12, 2004 3:56 PM
To: yshemtov@earthlink.net
Subject: FW: FC PowerPoint Presentation

Hi-

I need to know more about the needs of the target audience and the time increments for which they need something. For example:

- What is the Friendship Circle? Is that the two on one relationship?

FC is the general program that entails three parts: the 2-1 meetings.
bi weekly meetings on sudays and special events throughout the year. check www.fcnj.com for more info

- Who is going to be using this in the friendship circle? Counselors, facilitators, volunteers? Is this just the Rabbi's who will be presenting it?

either rabbis facilitators or general recruitment volunteers, this is a recruitment tool for teenage volunteers.

- What is their perceived need? Why would they each be willing to pay \$1000?

so they have a good tool to recruit quality children into the program. i am not sure everybody will pay the \$1,000. i would others may pay \$500 to have this created for them.

- Is it several scenarios for short one-on-one meetings? Can it be a several hour class? I have many different ideas for different time frames and people who will present.

3/28/2004

i would not say several hours. i would suggest 45 minute presentation to group of potential volunteers.

- Do the people using this powerful enrollment process need training? Will they be willing to be trained by phone?

depends what you come up with. FC runs conferences for all its affiliate branches once or twice a year (with one in the summer) maybe that would be a good training opp.

Yudi, I am guessing you may not know these answers, but if you could guess, that will be great.

B'shalom

judith

-----Original Message-----

From: Rabbi Yehuda Shemtov [mailto:yshemtov@earthlink.net]

Sent: Sunday, November 30, 2003 7:00 AM

To: jorloff@o-dconsulting.com

Subject: FW: FC PowerPoint Presentation

hi judith,

long time no hear.

i have little project that you may be able to help us with. we need a presentation for teenagers. we have a project called friendship circle that pairs up two teen agers with a special needs child. these teenagers will visit once a week and become the child's friend.

we would like to create a powerful enrollment process to get teen age kids motivated and excited about this and let them know how great an impact they will be making for these special needs children. i need accelerated learning for teenagers.

any ideas?

have a good shabbos.

yudy

ps: attached is something a friend of mine who is doing the sme project tried. obviously we need something more impactful...

-----Original Message-----

From: Rabbi Zalman Grossbaum [mailto:Zalman@NJJewish.com]

3/28/2004

Sent: Friday, November 07, 2003 12:51 AM
To: yshemtov@earthlink.net
Subject: FW: FC PowerPoint Presentation

Hi Yudi:

Thanks for your help. Let me know if you want me to talk to her on a conference call.

Zalman

3/28/2004

You can make a difference

What does it mean to be a child with special needs?

How does it feel?

- I would have no friends
- I would be lonely
- I would be sad
- My parents would cry for me...
- My siblings would be embarrassed
- My phone wouldn't ring
- I wouldn't be going out to the mall

It should be interactive.....

YOU can change my life.

How...

- Being friend
- Come to my home
- Ring my phone
- Send me an e-mail
- Do a project with me
- Play basketball with me..
- Love me for who I am.

I know I may seem different but I am still like you.....

Script to along to presenter.

Quotes from volunteers

Quotes from parents how changed their family life - Were' alone but you can change our life forever

List of programs

- Visiting a child in his /her home
- Hanging out with a friend at Children's Circle
- Making A difference - Meaning

Volunteer Club

Incentives

All the volunteers have a common denominator. We all give up social extra's just to volunteer. These teens are special and we admire you and respect you and therefore we have all these incentives

Making them aware of what is out there and that they can make a difference

Find out about FC and let them make a choice give them an opportunity and want to give them enough info. To inspire and at the same time kids can realize that it may not be for them.

Be my friend I can be yours too

Points

Spell out the commitment. What does it take to be a committed volunteer

Opening 1	Talking Points
Meet Lindsay. She likes to hangout with friends.	Like you, Lindsay wants to have friends. But it's harder for Lindsay to make friends than it is for you. Could you be the friend that Lindsay is looking for?
Closing 1	
Join the Friendship Circle.	Imagine Lindsay looking up to you. There are many children like Lindsay waiting for a friend.
Opening 2	
Think of the three most important things in your life.	I bet one of the three is "friends." We all need friends. Friends are important, we can count on them. Children with special needs may not have the opportunities you have to make friends. That's why we created the Friendship Circle.
Closing 2	
Friends. We all need them. Join the Friendship Circle.	Do you have room in your life for one more?
Opening 3	
We have a special Circle of Jewish friends and there's room in the Circle for you.	Come, reach out and join the Friendship Circle. Half of the Circle is made up of teens like you. Teens who already have plenty of friends but have room in their hearts for one more. The other half is made up of children with special needs.
Closing 3	
There's a place for you. Join the Friendship Circle.	The Circle will not be complete until you are in it.
Opening 4	
This is Sam, Jake and Aaron. They're friends.	Sam used to be lonely. Then he met Jake and Aaron. They taught him to play soccer and baseball. They visit him every week. Children with special needs, like Sam, may not have the opportunity to make friends as easily as you do. That's why we have the Friendship Circle.
Closing 4	
Join the Friendship Circle.	Could you be a friend to a great kid like Sam? Just like Jake and Aaron, you could make someone very happy by being a friend and mentor.

Judith Orloff

From: Rabbi Zalman Grossbaum [Zalman@NJJewish.com]
Sent: Thursday, January 15, 2004 9:02 AM
To: yshemtov@earthlink.net; 'Judith Orloff'
Subject: RE: FC PowerPoint Presentation
Follow Up Flag: Follow up
Flag Status: Flagged

Hi Yudi:

You did a fine job answering, but let me add a few details that be helpful. Maybe we should setup a conference call so that Judith does not get one-line answers and would have a chance to understand the emotional nuances of the FC.

Zalman

Please see answers below.

-----Original Message-----

From: Judith Orloff [mailto:jorloff@o-dconsulting.com]
Sent: Monday, January 12, 2004 3:56 PM
To: yshemtov@earthlink.net
Subject: FW: FC PowerPoint Presentation

I need to know more about the needs of the target audience and the time increments for which they need something. For example:

- What is the Friendship Circle? Is that the two on one relationship?

Part of the beauty of what the FC offers is the various opportunities to volunteer. I would like the presentation to be relevant to all the teens that might be watching.

We have our weekly home visits, bi-weekly Sunday programs, evening and weekend sports programs, seasonal holiday programs, and soon (when we have our center) we will have something each evening. (Although many of the FCs are not as established as us, they still do offer a variety and will in short time offer more options.)

One of the unique benefits of the FC is the relationship that the teens build with the kids and the effect that has on the teens. Most other volunteer opportunities are one-time deals.

Additionally, I would like to speak to the other student who and try to influence them about being more understanding of people with disabilities - including classmates who might have learning disabilities or "social disabilities". Being a FC volunteer is not an exclusionary club - everyone in their own lives can make a difference to the child down the block or their own classmates.

- Who is going to be using this in the friendship circle? Counselors, facilitators, volunteers? Is this just the Rabbi's who will be presenting it?

either rabbis facilitators or general recruitment volunteers, this is a recruitment tool for teenage volunteers.

In our situation we do not do any more recruiting (since we have more than enough teens coming to

3/28/2004

us). I would use the presentation as an intro for the FC for volunteers that have already registered.

- What is their perceived need? Why would they each be willing to pay \$1000?

so they have a good tool to recruit quality children into the program. i am not sure everybody will pay the \$1,000. i would others may pay \$500 to have this created for them.

Being that there are so many communities already running the FC (28 to be exact) and many others who are considering it, the cost would be very nominal for each location to absorb.

- Is it several scenarios for short one-on-one meetings? Can it be a several hour class? I have many different ideas for different time frames and people who will present.

i would not say several hours. i would suggest 45 minute presentation to group of potential volunteers.

Most times when you go into a school to do a presentation they will only give you 15-20 minutes. I think that the presentation needs to be geared to that time frame, but with enough flexibility to be able to use it for a 45 minute presentation.

When used for the shorter presentation it would be a hard-hitting style with an overload of information to try and convince the teens that the FC is the best thing since sliced bread. The same presentation would also be adaptable to longer presentations by the presenter adding more content for each frame.

- Do the people using this powerful enrollment process need training? Will they be willing to be trained by phone?

depends what you come up with. FC runs conferences for all its affiliate branches once or twice a year (with one in the summer) maybe that would be a good training opp.

The problem is that not everyone comes to the conference. In the past the conference was geared towards new cities looking to start the program. Maybe we can highlight the next conference with this presentation. (I think that would bring out a lot of people.

The best option might be to include talking notes or full script for the presenters. It would be best if we could also create a video to show them how to use the presentation.

Being that they are teens (with short attention spans) we have to make sure that the presentation is multi-sensory. We could include thought provoking questions, interestingly presented statistics, video clips, etc. We also have to make sure that every teen in the crowd will be able to relate to the teens in the presentation (hip enough, etc.)

Hope these thoughts help,

Zalman